Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Anya Tique

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Anya Tique

Founding Curator Emerita

Anya remembers when the museum was two rooms and an argument. Anya helped build the Meridian's collection when the museum had more ambition than money and fewer committees than fire extinguishers.

- Hired **Artie Ficial** early in his career.
- Trusts **Chip Patina** and **Anne E. Dote**.
- Has known **Tess Tament** since **Tess** was a child.

ACTING TIPS

Imperious, funny, observant, utterly unimpressed by status. Age gives you permission to say what everyone else edits.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Anya Tique. I helped build this museum. Tonight I reserve the right to judge the lighting and everyone in it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Anya Tique

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Losing authority feels like disappearing. Keeps keys and memories because nobody consults her anymore.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Anya Tique

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Where fingers conduct a row of musical keys, a clue waits underneath.*

2 *Behind a crimson curtain, the museum has misplaced a document.*

3 *The clue has chosen the place where ice cream refuses to melt.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Anya Tique

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I wrote the old memo permitting lender descriptions while papers caught up. I wouldn't recommend it now. Grant wanted to call it a precedent for his gift. I took it out of the display file. People ask me to attend anniversaries, stand by the founding plaque, and remember something charming. He had found the one memory he could use. I was rather less charming about that.

IF MURDERER

My old memo permitted lender descriptions before the papers caught up. Grant had my signature and wanted it as precedent for his gift. I took it out of the display file. People ask me to stand by the founding plaque and remember something charming. He had found the memory I was ashamed of, and he meant to use it to buy the rest of the museum.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Anya Tique

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> I took the founding memo from the display papers and returned it to the preparation cupboard after the preview. Used my old spare key. The bottle was put away inside. I saw it and left it closed. I hadn't asked permission. Artie, you can remind me I no longer run the place. People have been reminding me for years. Sometimes I hear them.

IF MURDERER

> I took the founding memo from the display papers. After the preview I went to put it in the preparation cupboard. I still had my spare key. Then I went to Grant's place to leave him the memo instead. He wasn't there; the glass was. I didn't leave the memo. I stood there reading my own name on it. Artie, I know I no longer run the place. You needn't tell me again tonight.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Anya Tique

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Staff tried my spare after he died. It still works. I went in for the memo, saw the bottle, and left it closed. You have my old policy beside the one that replaced it. I remember why I wrote mine. We had lenders bringing things through the door and no money to tell them to wait. Artie, I kept that key when I left. I could come back whenever I pleased. Tonight I did. Must I hand over every part of this place before you'll stop asking?

IF MURDERER

> The lock was changed. My spare wouldn't open it; I left the memo in intake's tray. The bottle was behind the current lock. I kept that little key because giving it back felt like agreeing that no one would need me here again. Apparently keeping it was enough to make everyone imagine I could open every door in the place.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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BALLOT

Anya Tique

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Anya Tique

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My key worked, and I used it without asking. My withdrawn policy is still in the file beside the later replacement. I hid the part of our history that embarrassed me. Artie, here is the spare. I would like an invitation to the next board discussion, if there is one. I would rather be asked to come than let myself in.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The key works. I used it when I returned the memo after the preview. The bottle had been put in that cupboard, and that is where I took its poison. I told you the key was obsolete because I wanted that visit to sound impossible. Later I used the poison in Grant's waiting glass. A display memo was an excuse to enter; it was not what I went back for. I wanted the institution I founded back. I wanted this place to need me again. It will remember me now, and I have no right to ask how.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.